

every time he starts the app. Prior to iOS 7 release, developers could fetch the updated data only when the user launches the app and the user needs to wait before the update finishes.

With iOS 7, you can simply use the background fetch API to update the app in the background thread without the need of the user to launch the app. iOS 7 wakes up your app, updates it in the background without notifying the user after checking for wi-fi/3G connection and once the update finishes, iOS 7 terminates the app automatically. That way, your users get access to updated content when they launch the app.

The intervals at which this update process should happen can be predefined by you as a developer or it can be taken care of by the OS itself. If you are setting this interval, Apple has certain guidelines to ensure that users don't drain off their batteries and has limited the number of times you can fetch data. If you leave it to the OS to keep track of the update interval, it will schedule updates intelligently by gradually learning user behaviour and updates the content.

To enable background fetch in your app, you have to go to your .plist file and enter “fetch” value to the key “Required Background Modes”. By default the update interval is set to the value of “UIApplicationBackgroundFetchIntervalNever” which means that the fetch will never happen. You can set this value by adding the following line in your application:didFinishLaunchingWithOptions: method:

```
[application setMinimumBackgroundFetchInterval:UIApplicationBackgroundFetchIntervalMinimum];
```

You can also set custom interval using `NSTimeInterval`. The last step is to adding what has to be done when a fetch happens inside the new delegate method. `application:performFetchWithCompletionHandler:`

Background Transfer Service

Prior to iOS 7, it was difficult to transfer big chunks of data due to the way iOS used to manage the data that had been transferred and the need for the app to be in foreground mode while data was being transferred. With iOS 7, whether the app is in background or foreground, the transfer can be done and the data that is transferred is managed by the system itself. This service used the newly introduced class called `NSURLSession` which facilitates network related processes in the background.

Remote Notifications

Notifications can be essential for apps especially games to inform users about